

Draft - expert review pending

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Unit 1 teacher notes

Sequencing note

The four topics run as one argument. Topic 1.1 establishes what computer literacy is (a skills bag much bigger than typing) and why it matters. Topic 1.2 gives the history and generations, which quietly widen what a "computer" is. Topic 1.3 turns that widened view into a two-axis classification. Topic 1.4 applies everything to society and to the fields trainees will work in. Teach them in order; the classification work in 1.3 falls flat if trainees still picture only a desktop machine.

Common misconceptions to probe

1. **"Computer literacy means knowing how to type."** The unit's central target. Probe it early: ask trainees to write down three things a computer-literate teacher can do, and count how many answers are only typing or scrolling. Then walk the five skill branches of the first figure against their lists.
2. **"A computer is only the desktop machine on a desk."** Probe during Topic 1.2 after the smartphone point: ask how many computers are in the room right now, counting phones, watches and anything with a screen or a controller inside it.
3. **"Each new generation of computers is simply bigger and faster in every way."** Probe with the ENIAC-versus-phone comparison: which machine is bigger, which is faster, which is cheaper? Let the paradox resolve into "smaller, cheaper, more reliable, and faster".
4. **"ICT means computers only, not phones or networks."** Probe in Topic 1.1's ICT definition and again in 1.4's Pakistan access figures, where the phone is the majority device.

Managing the activities

Topic 1.1 - ICT skills audit (20 minutes, pairs). The trap is inflated self-ratings. Insist partners compare a specific task ("show me how you would attach the file") rather than trading adjectives. Keep the two chosen skills visible; Unit 6 returns to them.

Topic 1.2 - Generation gallery walk (20 minutes, groups of three or four). The trap is sorting by age or size rather than by the defining technology. When a group defends a placement, ask: "Which technology inside the machine puts it there?" A machine from the 1960s built of transistors is second-generation even if it is large.

Topic 1.3 - Device detective (20 minutes, pairs). The trap is the embedded class: trainees often forget devices with no screen. Push: "Does the washing machine think, or is a computer inside it doing one job?" Also watch for the hybrid answer given to any device with a sensor; the alarm-and-numbers example in the explanation is the model to point back to.

Topic 1.4 - ICT in my field (25 minutes, groups, jigsaw). The trap is generic answers ("ICT helps farmers"). Require a named application and a source for the Pakistan example. If a group cannot find one, that is the moment to model a quick, careful search on the class projector.

Working with the guide's strategies

This unit naturally carries the guide's five instructional strategies. **Lectures** carry the explanation sections; keep them short and stop at each figure.

Interactive discussion and **question-answer sessions** fit the misconception probes above; run them before revealing each correction. **Demonstrations** are strongest in Topics 1.1 and 1.2: open a real spreadsheet, attach a real file to an email, and show a punched-card image next to a microprocessor. **Case study analysis** is Topic 1.4's territory: the two-classrooms opening and the homework-portal RRQ are ready-made cases; add a local one from your own institution if you have it.

Practical work and practicum links

The guide's practical work list maps onto this unit as follows.

- **Hands-on computer exercises:** the skills audit's five tasks (spreadsheet entry, email attachment, video search, notice preparation, backup) are the unit's hands-on core. If a lab is available, give every trainee one supervised attempt at each by the end of Topic 1.1.
- **Individual assignments:** the Topic 1.2 computing family tree and the Topic 1.4 impact analysis are individual written products.
- **Group assignments:** the generation gallery walk and the ICT-in-my-field jigsaw are group tasks with individual reporting back.
- **Internet research tasks:** the Pakistan example hunt in Topic 1.4's activity is a guided research task; require a source for every fact.
- **Presentations:** the jigsaw traveller role is a low-stakes presentation; stronger trainees can present their family tree or impact analysis to the class.

Each topic carries a "Try this at your practicum school" task. Set them up before trainees leave for practicum and debrief in the first session after they return; the equipment inventory (Topic 1.3) and the staff interview (Topic 1.4) produce material the later units reuse, especially Unit 2's lab audit.

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